Tom de Gay

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Product design leader
14 years in hands-on product design
Complex platforms, data and automation

Profile

Product designer with 14 years experience, on top of 7 years in wayfinding. I was first designer at Quantemplate and helped grow it into a trusted enterprise platform. Along the way, I've adapted to many different problem domains, stakeholders and constraints. Hands-on through discovery, strategy, design and delivery, with AI now extending how I build and test.

Experience

Quantemplate
Enterprise data platform enabling insurance organisations to integrate, transform and validate complex commercial data through no-code workflows. Trusted by AXA, Aegon, Chubb, Everest and Sompo, processing 3.4 billion rows annually.

Head of Design | Product Leadership
2021–Present

Hands-on product design whilst shaping strategic direction, closely informed by client feedback.

- Architected semantic layer that improved usability and performance across the product, with upgraded column mapping reducing serious errors by 73% in testing.
- Proposed and delivered Feeds, connecting 67 organisations to share data and build network intelligence. This unlocked a new growth strategy for the business.
- Improved validation workflows, introducing corrections and sharing features. Client feedback: 'The speed at which we can work now is a real step change'.
- Defined the automation framework and permissions system, removing 16,200 manual steps per client per year with clear access controls and auditability.
- Introduced AI prototyping, shortening feedback loops from a day's work to minutes.

Head of Design
2016–21

Led design through the company's pivot, 10x ARR growth and Series A from leading Silicon Valley investors. Business grew to serve clients in USA, UK and Europe.

- Delivered the data transformation product experience across 30+ functions, making complex capabilities accessible to business users, responsible for 100% sales.
- Made ease of use a key differentiator consistently cited by clients and new hires.
- Migrated design tooling and created a scalable design system and hand-off layer in close collaboration with engineering. Reduced round-trip time substantially and UI drift to zero.
- Authored the product knowledge base of 100+ articles, enabling customers to learn and troubleshoot independently, reducing support requests to just 3 per client per year.
- Hired and managed 4 people across design, development and marketing. Introduced OKRs to the company. Enabled career progression for reports and mentored senior designer in UX.
- Led the brand rollout across digital, video and print, setting a distinctive standard in the sector through exceptional information design, illustration and production craft.

Founding Product Designer
2012–16

Joined a four-person team as first designer, finding product-market fit in fintech/insurtech.

- Established product brand, shipped best-in-class self-serve dashboarding/reporting tools.
- Helped team secure Smart funding, seed round and first Techstars London cohort, 2013.

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Experience

Placefield | Independent design consultancy
2012–Present

Independent design practice spanning education and productivity tools, adapting to different domains and working directly with founders to turn early concepts into usable products.

- Image Insight (2026). Digital coaching tool. Turned MVP into an elegant, low-friction experience with positive user feedback. Coded functional prototype and deployed design system as code. Currently in beta testing in two schools.
- Zonefully (2021). A new model for planning activities around long-term goals. Translated the founder's model into a coherent interface, bringing the concept to a functioning v1.

Avanti Architects | Wayfinding designer
2005–12

- Design lead on wayfinding projects spanning strategy, information design and environmental graphics. Contributed to award-winning projects (RIBA, Civic Trust, Crown Estate).
- Projects included audit, strategy, planning and execution for complex sites such as Bristol Southmead Hospital (600k visitors/year), Pontefract Hospital (100k visitors/year), Haggerston School (1,100 pupils) and University of Sheffield.
- Wayfinding design principles continue to underpin my practice.

Leeds Beckett University | Visiting Lecturer
2005–16

- Teaching, mentoring and opening up possibilities for around 300 final-year students in Graphic Design, Fine Art and Contemporary Art Practices.

Education

MA Communication Design | Distinction
2003–05 | Central Saint Martins | University of the Arts London

Specialised in information design and wayfinding, exploring how design helps people understand and navigate complex environments.

BA (Hons) Graphic Arts and Design | First Class
2000–03 | Leeds Beckett University

Additional Roles

Design for Complexity Meetup | Co-Founder
2018–20

Meetup for people involved in the design of complex products. Grew membership to 500 and ran several in-person events with insightful talks from industry leaders.

Isokon Gallery | Trustee | Design Lead
2014–Present

Co-founded and co-designed award-winning micro museum in London, dedicated to the story of modernist architecture, design and urban living. 50k visitors and counting.

Expertise

Skills
UX & Interaction design · Information architecture · Systems thinking · Complex workflows · Design systems · Data visualisation · Cross-functional collaboration · AI-assisted prototyping

Domains
Design for AI and agents · Complex systems · Enterprise SaaS · Data products · Workflow automation · Analytics · Financial and insurance data · Data sharing

Tools
Claude Code · Codex · v0 · Lovable · Storybook · Figma including variables and modes · After Effects · Adobe Suite · GitHub · HTML/CSS

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